

Lisbon, Portugal

7:50pm

I take an elevator from below the ground up into the moonlit square. The floor, covered in hand laid black and white checkered mosaic patterns, reflects the waxing moonlight glow. A tall dark angel stands on a marble pillar in the center, grasping chains broken free. In the soft light I can see magenta flowers and colorful buildings resting for the night.

12:33 am

As I write I'm sitting at a desk with a cool breeze touching my skin. The window casts a soft orange glow around the room. Through it I see gently blinking lights of houses and at the top of a hill sits a massive castle in the distance. The stars and moon cover the streets with a dim glow. Here in Portugal, noise past 11pm is banned. The stillness is eerily relaxing.

Every single street corner and room is adorned in perfect detail as if hand painted by a divine creator. The first streets I walk through are lined with mosaic tiles, the walls shades of pink and yellow and white and red. Twice I walk past a three dimensional brain plastered to a wall, captivatingly strange. Tall flowering trees shade winding staircases and bloom out of window sills. The air is warm but cooled by the mist. Inside each building, a palace unfolds. Looking up, towering white ceilings adorned with ornate patterns cast the rooms in proud beauty. Even bathrooms are lined with hand painted mosaics in shades of blue. Everything appears to be in harmonic contrast. All over the city, shades of ocean blue are set against blood red.